



# ARTICLE 42

## Parking and Loading Standards

Annual Town Meeting || April 27, 2026

*Kin Lau, Chair*  
*Arlington Redevelopment Board*



# Parking and Loading Standards

- Article 42 was a result of a discussion by members of the Redevelopment Board in December 2025, following approval of an applicant's request to reduce the drive aisle width on a proposed development to 22 feet from the required 24 feet.
- In reviewing mixed-use projects, it is difficult to balance the desire for larger commercial spaces with meeting parking requirements.

Narrowing the drive aisle is a small change, but it creates an opportunity for slightly larger commercial spaces.

- In reviewing the bylaws of neighboring communities, the Board found that the widths vary between 20 to 24 feet, so the proposed change is in keeping with the requirements of other municipalities.



## Drive Aisle Widths in Surrounding Communities

| Town/<br>City                                                   | Required Minimum Drive Aisle Width (in feet) |            |                           |                                             |                                                                   |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|------------|---------------------------|---------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                                                 | Parallel                                     | 30°        | 45°                       | 60°                                         | 90°                                                               |
| Melrose                                                         | 12 one-way<br>20 two-way                     | 11 one-way | 13 one-way                | 18 one-way                                  | 20 residential/mixed-use<br>with residential<br>24 all other uses |
| Belmont*                                                        | 13 one-way                                   | 12 one-way | 13 one-way                | 18 one-way                                  | 24 standard & compact                                             |
| Winchester                                                      | 12 one-way                                   | 11 one-way | 13 one-way                | 18 one-way                                  | 20 one-way<br>22 two-way overnight<br>24 other two-way            |
| Lexington                                                       | ---                                          | ---        | 14 standard<br>13 compact | 16 standard<br>15 compact                   | 22 standard<br>20 compact                                         |
| Cambridge                                                       | ---                                          | ---        | ---                       | 22 standard<br>20 compact<br>22 handicapped | 22 standard<br>20 compact<br>22 handicapped                       |
| Somerville                                                      | 12 one-way<br>20 two-way                     | ---        | 12 one-way<br>n/a two-way | 12 one-way<br>n/a two-way                   | n/a one-way<br>20 two-way                                         |
| * Standards shall serve as a guide for Planning Board decisions |                                              |            |                           |                                             |                                                                   |





# AMENDMENT TEXT

## Article 42



# AMENDMENT TEXT

Amend Section 6.1.11.C.(3), as follows:

## 6.1.11 Parking and Loading Space Standards

C. All parking and loading areas containing over five spaces, including automotive and drive-in establishments of all types, shall be paved and subject to the following:

- (3) Each required off-street parking space shall have direct access to an aisle or driveway having a minimum width of ~~24~~ 22 feet in the case of two-way traffic or the following widths in the case of one-way traffic only:

| Angle of parking | Minimum                    |
|------------------|----------------------------|
| Parallel         | 12 ft                      |
| 30 deg           | 11 ft                      |
| 45 deg           | 13 ft                      |
| 60 deg           | 18 ft                      |
| 90 deg           | <del>24</del> <u>22</u> ft |

